

NATALIA CANTET

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📍 School of Public Health, Augusta University, Augusta, Georgia

🌐 [Linkedin Profile](#) Citizenship: USA/Argentina

Research, Health, Health Economics, Econometrics, Causal Inference

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I aim to collaborate with others to create a research portfolio focused on understanding issues affecting women and minorities in the USA, as well as in other vulnerable contexts. Additionally, I aim to explore the linkages between behaviors, well-being, and health outcomes of these groups, and the impact of policies and global events on those outcomes. I utilize several methodologies, including graphical and descriptive analysis, statistical analysis aimed at understanding the social determinants of health, and causal approaches.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Fellow, School of Public Health, Augusta University

July 2024 - Present

- Compiled, analyzed, and interpreted a large dataset of Emergency Room Visits in the U.S. using **Stata 18**.
- Applied advanced machine learning algorithms to examine the social determinants of mental health-related ED visits using **Stata 18** and **Python**.
- Presented research findings to experts across disciplines, tailoring explanations to varying levels of technical expertise.
- Conducted research projects currently under review in reputable Public Health and Economics journals.

Visiting Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, University of South Carolina

August 2023 - May 2024

- Conducted research leading to two publications in reputable Global Health and Business Economics journals.
- Mentored a minority graduate student, providing guidance on research and professional development.
- Attended conferences and research seminars, fostering collaborations with academic peers.
- Designed and delivered undergraduate courses in Introductory Microeconomics and Introductory Econometrics to freshmen, junior, and senior students.

Assistant Professor, School of Economics and Finance, Universidad EAFIT

July 2020 - April 2023

- Led research projects resulting in three publications in Development Economics and Global Health journals.
- Secured external and internal research funding through competitive grant applications.
- Designed and implemented a rural survey incorporating a behavioral field experiment and multiple survey modules.
- Reviewed academic journal manuscripts, providing constructive feedback to authors.
- Developed collaborations with researchers across four countries.
- Designed and taught undergraduate and graduate courses in Intermediate Microeconomics, Statistics, and Development Economics.
- Supervised multiple undergraduate research projects from proposal development to final presentation.
- Advised graduate thesis students, offering research support and constructive feedback on drafts.

EDUCATION

2020: **University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign**, Urbana, IL. *Ph.D. in Economics*

2014: **Universidad Nacional de la Plata**, La Plata, Buenos Aires. *M.S. in Economics*

2010: **Universidad Torcuato Di Tella**, Buenos Aires, Argentina. *B.S. in Economics*

PUBLICATIONS

Cantet, N. “Does maternal schooling lead to improvements in child health? Evidence from Ethiopia” *Accepted at Education Economics*

Cantet, N., Feld, B. & Pea-Rojas, E. **Women-led ventures: target margins in emerging markets**. *Small Business Econ* (2024). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11187-024-00962-8>

Cantet, N, Ibañez, M, Muñoz-Mora JC, & Quintero LM. **Determinants of COVID-19 Vaccination Take-Up in Remote Rural Areas: Evidence From Colombia**. *Int J Public Health*. 2024 Jun 13;69:1606689. doi: 10.3389/ijph.2024.1606689. PMID: 38939517; PMCID: PMC11208315.

Cantet, N, Feld, B, & Hernández, M (2024). **Is there discrimination against children of same-sex households? Evidence from an experimental study in Colombia**. *Labour Economics*, 87, 102507.

Alzua, M, Cantet, N, Dammert, A Olajide, D. **The Well-being Effects of an Old-Age Pension: Experimental Evidence for Ekiti State in Nigeria**. *Journal of African Economies*, Volume 33, Issue 3, 1 June 2024, Pages 240270, <https://doi.org/10.1093/jae/ejad012>

Chama-Chiliba, C.M., Hangoma, P., Cantet, N., Funjika, P., Koyi, G. and Alza, M.L. (2022), **Monetary Incentives and Early Initiation of Antenatal Care: A Matched-Pair, Parallel Cluster-Randomized Trial in Zambia**. *Studies in Family Planning*, 53: 595-615. <https://doi.org/10.1111/sifp.12215>

WORKING PAPERS

“Predicting Emergency Mental Health Care Use in Adults with IDD: A Machine Learning Approach”

“Womens Fertility and Labor Force Participation: Evidence of Changing Social Gender with Grey Ceballos and Monica Hernandez. *forthcoming at Research in Labor Economics*

“Adults with intellectual disabilities and cerebral palsy have greater injurious falls at earlier ages in the emergency department relative to the general adult population” Natalia Cantet, Teal Benevides, Deborah Jehu, Michelle Meade, Mike Mckee and Haylie Miller. *Under review at Annals of Family Medicine*

“The Effects of Increasing Community Participation on School Management Outcomes: Evidence from India” with Clara Delavallade, Alan Griffith, Zhe Liu and Rebecca Thornton. *Under review at The Journal of Development Studies*

“Shifting Sentiments: Exploring the Effects of Colombia’s 2018 FIFA World Cup Performance on Political Opinion” with Laura Quintero, Andres Ochoa and Juan Camilo Mujica

“Who makes the decisions in Mining Areas? Evidence From the Antioquian Gold Rush with Juan Carlos Muñoz and Laura Quintero

“Gender and Value of Decision-making Within the Household: Experimental Evidence from Colombia” with Marcela Ibanez, Tatiana Orozco-Garcia and Gerhard Riener

“The Effect of Teenage Pregnancy on Schooling and Labor Force Participation: Evidence From Urban South Africa”

“Premarital Fertility in Liberia: Exploring Predictors of Early Sexual Debut and Pregnancy Among Adolescent Girls in Monrovia”. with Shelley Clark, Tricia Koroknay-Palicz, and Michelle Poulin

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Acceptance and Impact of introducing sliding scale payment policy into CBHI in Ethiopia: Randomized controlled trial with Maria Laura Alzua and Zewdie Birhanu

Building Healthy Homes: The Effect of Home Improvement on the Use of Practices that Contribute to Conflict Reduction and Domestic Violence Prevention with Marcela Inbañez, Juan Carlos Muñoz and Mariantonia Lemos

Mental health Visits to the ED and Broad Band in the US

PRESENTATIONS

2025: Podium Presentations at Gatlinburg 2025 , INSAR 2025, and AcademyHealth ARM 2025

2024: RRTC Workshop University of Michigan.

2023: Impact Evaluation Network of the Latin American and Caribbean Economic Association

2022: Universidad Nacional de La Plata; ANDE Network Seminar; Carolina Region Empirical Economics Day; Brown Bag Seminar at University of South Carolina

2021: Ministerio de Salud, Uruguay; University of Goettingen

2020: 2020 AAEA Virtual Meeting; American Economics Association and CSMGEP session, San Diego CA

2019: Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting, Mo; University of Illinois, Department of Economics; LACEA's Health Network Workshop, Universidad del Pacífico; Sustainability and Development Conference, University Of Michigan; Washington University Economics Graduate Student Conference, Washington University in St. Louis, MO; Illinois Economics Association Annual Meeting, DePaul University; Southern Economics Association Annual Meeting, Fort Lauderdale FL.

2018: Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting, Evanston IL; Midwest International Development Conference, University of Minnesota

2017: Missouri Valley Economics Association Annual Conference, Kansas City MO.

EXTERNAL GRANTS

2023 - 2026: FID Strengthening the National Community-Based Health Insurance (CBHI) in Ethiopia - with Maria Laura Alzua, Zewdie Birhanu, Desta Hiko and Morankar Sudhakar

2023 - 2024: IADB GDLab Gender-based violence against women, children, and adolescents - with Marcela Ibañez and Juan Carlos Muñoz

2023: EfD - All that glitters is not gold? Approaching the sub-national and spatial impact of a gold rush and policy changes with Marcela Ibañez , Carlos Adrian Saldarriaga and Mauricio Oyarzo

2022: IADB LGBTQ+ Persons in Latin America and the Caribbean: Measuring Population Sizes And Obstacles To Economic and Social Inclusion -with Brian Feld and Monica Hernandez

2021-2022: ANDE-IDRC Experience of women entrepreneurs participating in venture accelerator programs (Principal Investigator)- with Brian Feld

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Professional Memberships

2021 - Present: Mentor, Scientific Support Team, Policy Impact Evaluation Research Initiative (PIERI), Partnership for Economic Policy (PEP)

2021 - 2022: Academic advising for EAFIT and the Ministry of Education - Evaluation of technology usage in Colombian primary schools

Department Academic Services

2021- 2022: Evaluation of programs for Fundacion Mi Sangre with Prof. Elenora Davalos

2021: Universidad EAFIT - Internal committee to review and reform the Ph.D. program

Referee Activity

Refereeing: Current Research Journal of Social Sciences and Humanities, Economics of Education Review, PEP, Social Science Research, Journal of economic behavior & organization

Other Services

April 6-8, 2017: World Bank Course Facilitator Evaluating the Impact of Education and Health Policy in Guatemala

AWARDS

2020: Committee on the Status of Minority Groups in the Economics Profession (CSMGEP) Travel Grant.

2016: Summer research award, University of Illinois.

2014-2020: Merit-based full scholarship for graduate studies, University of Illinois.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of South Carolina

- Principles of Microeconomics (Spring 2024)
- Introductory Econometrics (Fall 2023 & Spring 2024)

Universidad EAFIT

- Graduate level
 - Quantitative Methods (Masters in Applied Economics - Fall 2022)
 - Development Economics (Economics Ph.D. - Fall 2022)
 - Quantitative Methods (Masters in Behaviour Science - Spring 2022)
 - Masters Rural Development Economics (Masters in Applied Economics - Fall 2021)
- Undergrad level
 - Introduction to Microeconomics (Fall 2020 & Spring 2022)
 - Development Economics and Growth (Spring - Fall 2021)
 - Microeconomics Seminar (Fall 2020 - Spring 2021)
 - Intermediate Microeconomics (Fall 2022)

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native)

English (advanced)

PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

Programming skills: Stata (Advanced), Python (basic)

Empathy - Learner - Developer - Includer - Positivity - Resilience